



SIX PILLARS

**Making Efficient
Affordable**



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Who & What is Six Pillars?

With over 35 years of combined experience in developing SaaS-based workflow applications, Six Pillars stands poised to revolutionize cloud resource management for businesses. Our core mission is to simplify the complexities of cloud cost analysis and resource optimization, providing users with intuitive tools to enhance efficiency and reduce costs. By automating optimization processes, we eliminate the risks and challenges associated with managing cloud services.



The problem we've found

Cloud hosting providers often present billing structures that appear affordable initially but can lead to cost overruns as companies scale and resource utilization grows. This cost inflation is exacerbated by pricing models that are complex and opaque, making it difficult for businesses to understand and manage their cloud spending effectively.

Without the right tools, businesses find themselves **paying for underutilized resources**, impacting their profitability and operational efficiency.



How are we going to solve it?

Six Pillars offers a comprehensive cloud management platform that addresses these challenges head-on.

Key features include:

Intuitive Interfaces: Our user-friendly interface makes cloud data accessible and understandable for users of all skill levels, from novices to seasoned professionals.

Affordable Pricing: We provide enterprise-level optimization at a price point accessible to startups and small businesses, ensuring cost-effective management of cloud resources.

Scalable Technology: Our platform is designed to scale alongside our customers, supporting them from startup to scale-up without the need for costly transitions or migrations.



What do we have to show?

Our proof of concept caters specifically to small businesses and individuals, offering accessible solutions to their cloud resource management needs. With simplified visualizations and cost analysis, users can easily identify savings opportunities and implement efficient resource utilization strategies.

Our platform provides comprehensive support for implementation and volume management, ensuring users can optimize their cloud usage without technical complexities. Designed for simplicity and affordability, our proof of concept empowers small businesses and individuals to maximize efficiency and minimize costs in their cloud operations.



User Story

Stewart Phillips

Age: 28

Boise, Idaho

Stewart is a co-founder of a tech startup. He's in his late 20s and juggles multiple roles, including managing cloud resources. With a limited budget and a small team, Stewart is always looking for efficient and cost-effective solutions.

" I need an AWS optimization tool that is easy to use and helps manage resources effectively, so that we can focus on growing our business without being overwhelmed by cloud management complexities and costs. "



Welcome Stewart!

Gain insights into the health and performance of your AWS account. Here's a snapshot of what you've achieved with our services so far, helping you manage resources efficiently and cost-effectively.

78 Cost Savings Opportunities Identified

36% Projected Savings Over The Next Year

Current Monthly AWS Spending

\$2,239

198 Number of Active Instances	50% Average CPU Utilization	11TB Total Snapshot Storage Used	31 Underutilized Resources
94 Number of Volumes	42 S3 Bucket Count	115 Number of Running Databases	243 Lambda Function Count

Quick Links

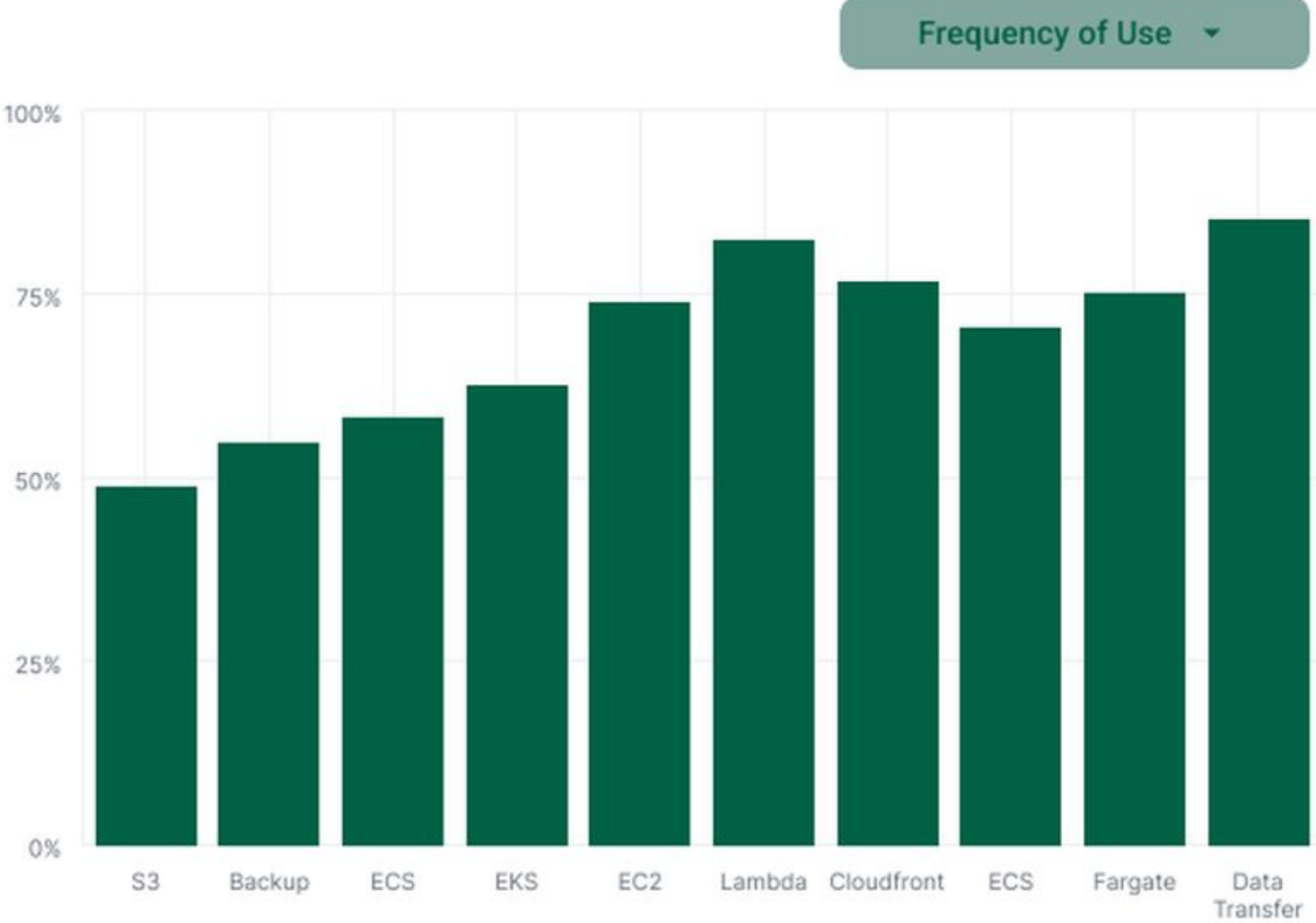
- Account Management
- Resources
- Backups

Track Your AWS Spending Over Time

Understanding your AWS costs is crucial for effective budget management. Our Cost Trend Graph offers a clear visual representation of your spending patterns. Whether you're scaling up operations or optimizing existing resources, this graph helps you monitor the financial impact of your AWS usage. By breaking down costs by service, you can pinpoint areas where spending is highest and identify opportunities for cost savings.

Frequency of Use

Understanding the frequency of use of your AWS resources is pivotal for efficient cloud management. This view provides insights into how often each service is accessed and utilized, highlighting potential areas for optimization. Regularly used resources might need scaling to ensure optimal performance, while infrequently used services could be candidates for downsizing or reconfiguration.



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Volume Management

Volume Management provides a comprehensive overview of each volume in your AWS account, displaying crucial details like size, type, and cost. Utilize our innovative Six Pillar Optimization System to efficiently modify and optimize your volumes, ensuring optimal performance and cost-effectiveness.

View Backups



Refresh Data

Urgency

1-8

43% Utilized	EC2 vol-0a1b2c3d4e5f67890	Fixed	25 backups	400 days last modified	High Optimization Potential
10% Utilized	EC2 vol-1b2c3d4e5f6a78901	High CPU Usage	78 backups		High Optimization Potential
25% Utilized	RDS vol-3d4e5f6a7b8c90123	3 backups	400 days last modified		High Optimization Potential
61% Utilized	S3 vol-2c3d4e5f6a7b89012	2 backups	100 days last modified		Moderate Optimization Potential
71% Utilized	RDS vol-4e5f6a7b8c9d01234				Low Optimization Potential
70% Utilized	RDS vol-5f6a7b8c9d0e12345				Low Optimization Potential
75% Utilized	RDS vol-6a7b8c9d0e1f23456				Low Optimization Potential
66% Utilized	RDS vol-7b8c9d0e1f2a34567				Low Optimization Potential

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Resource Overview

Take a look at your resource and determine if it's ready to be optimized.

[View Analysis](#)[Optimize Volume](#)

Volume ID:

vol-0a1b2c3d4e5f67890

Instance ID:

i-12345abc

Created:

2022-05-14 08:06:12

Status:

In-use

Type:

GP3

Utilization:

43%

Last Modified

2023-03-08 16:31:53

Size:

1000

GB

IOPS:

N/A

Throughput:

125

MB/s

Backup Alerts

We recommend setting a retention period on all of your backups even if the period is 1-2 years. There is currently 25 backups created off of this resource, 22 of which have a retention period set.

Backup ID	Creation Date	Size (GB)	Retention Period
backup-001	2023-01-10	150	NONE
backup-001	2023-02-10	160	NONE
backup-001	2023-03-10	155	NONE

Snapshot Alerts

We recommend deleting Failed or Errored snapshots that are over 6 months of age. In most cases this caused by general account neglect and should be removed.

Snapshot ID	Creation Date	Size (GB)	Status
snap-101	2023-01-10	100	Error
snap-102	2023-02-10	100	Failed

Activity Log

Action: **Volume type changed**

Type changed from gp2 to io1 for higher IOPS

Performed By: John Doe (User)

2024-03-01T23:20:15.147Z

Action: **Performance analysis performed**

Analysis suggested potential IOPS optimization

Performed By: 6 Pillars Optimizer

2024-03-01T23:20:15.147Z

Action: **IOPS configuration modified**

IOPS increased from 3000 to 4000

Performed By: System Admin

2024-03-01T23:20:15.147Z

Action: **Snapshot Creation**

Snapshot snap-456def created for backup purposes

Performed By: 6 Pillars Optimizer

2024-03-01T23:20:15.147Z

Action: **Cost Analysis Report Generated**

Report indicated a 15% cost saving since last month

Performed By: 6 Pillars Optimizer

2024-03-01T23:20:15.147Z

[Export Activity Log](#)

Based on our analysis, your volume is over-provisioned for the current data needs.



Utilization Trends

Data Stored

430 GB

Volume Size

1000 GB

Consider downsizing the volume to more closely match the current data usage. Reducing the volume size can lower storage costs without impacting performance, as long as it aligns with your data growth expectations.



Cost Implications

Average Monthly Cost

\$300

Estimated Monthly Cost Post-Optimization

\$200

By following these recommendations, you can optimize your volume to better match your actual storage needs, leading to a significant reduction in monthly costs while maintaining performance and scalability.

Suggestion: Our regular data management service is key to sustaining cost efficiency, keeping your storage optimized and your expenses in check. Trust Six Pillars to maintain the balance between your resource utilization and cost savings.

[Export Analysis](#)

Export your volume analysis for immediate insights, and rest assured, we also store this data to track and evaluate changes over time, ensuring continuous optimization.

[Edit on AWS](#)[Delete Volume](#)

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Optimization Process Ahead

Important Notice: You are about to initiate the optimization process for your selected volume. Please be aware that optimization can be a **destructive process**, which may result in changes or alterations to your volume's configuration and data.

Backup Creation: As a safety measure, we automatically create a backup of the resource before any optimization is performed. This backup serves as a safeguard, allowing you to restore the volume to its pre-optimization state if needed. The backup created will be tagged for easy identification, with a tag indicating that it was generated as part of an optimization procedure.

Your Responsibilities

- **Testing Post-Optimization:** It is crucial for you to thoroughly test the optimized volume to ensure that the optimization process has been successful and that your volume functions as expected.
- **Backup Verification:** We also recommend that you test the backup to confirm its integrity and completeness. This step is essential to ensure that you have a reliable fallback option.



I understand that the optimization process is potentially destructive and that it is my responsibility to test the optimized volume and the backup. I acknowledge that I have read and understood this warning.

Proceed with Optimization on vol-01abcdefghijklmnopqrstuvwxyz

Cancel and Return to Previous Page

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Resource Optimizer Settings

Set the Optimized Resource ID, Backup ID, and tags used for documentation.

Load Preset

Save as Preset

Original Volume ID:

vol-0a1b2c3d4e5f67890

Optimized

Optimized Volume ID

vol-0a1b2c3d4e5f67890

Tag

ⓘ A UID tag is added to every volume we optimize: '6PO-1890742'

Backup

Backup ID

vol-0a1b2c3d4e5f67890

Tag

ⓘ A UID tag is added to every backup we create: '6PB-0189023'

Commence!

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Storage Management Account



Optimizer

Hang Tight! We're optimizing your resource, your results will be here shortly



Optimization Strategy Formulation

Developing a tailored plan to compress and optimize data without compromising integrity or accessibility.

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Optimizer Results

We've collected a summary of the resource, cost and energy improvements completed by the resource optimizer

vol-0a1b2c3d4e5f67890

was successfully optimized!

Export Comparison

Feel free to export the detailed optimization comparison report, providing you with a comprehensive and accessible record of the improvements and savings achieved.

Resource ID: res-101

SP Reference #: 6104888294

Original

Volume ID:

vol-0a1b2c3d4e5f67890



Instance ID:

i-12345abc

Created:

2022-05-14 08:06:12

Status:

In-use

Type:

GP3

Throughput:

125

MB/s

IOPS:

N/A

Optimized

Volume ID:

vol-0a1b2c3d4e5f67890



Instance ID:

i-12345abc

Created:

2024-04-08 14:15:12

Status:

In-use

Type:

GP3

Throughput:

125

MB/s

IOPS:

N/A

Expenses

Explore the financial implications of optimization in the Cost/Spending Section, where historical spending trends and projected costs post-optimization are displayed. Gain insights into potential cost reductions and understand how optimization can lead to significant financial savings.

25%

Percentage Savings

Cost Savings

\$300 /month

Pre-Optimization cost

\$1200 /month



Post-Optimization cost

\$900 /month

Be aware that AWS automatically adjusts the size of your resources to meet demand, which, without vigilant monitoring, can lead to a gradual and often unnoticed increase in costs. This underscores the importance of regular reviews and optimizations to keep your expenses aligned with your actual needs and prevent budget overruns.



Space & Utilization

Step into the Utilization Section to assess how your resource's storage space is being utilized and the effectiveness of data management post-optimization. This area highlights the reduction in data footprint, showcasing how optimization leads to more efficient use of storage space and aligns with your data management strategies.

40%

Reduction of Data on Volume

Total Space Savings

200 GB

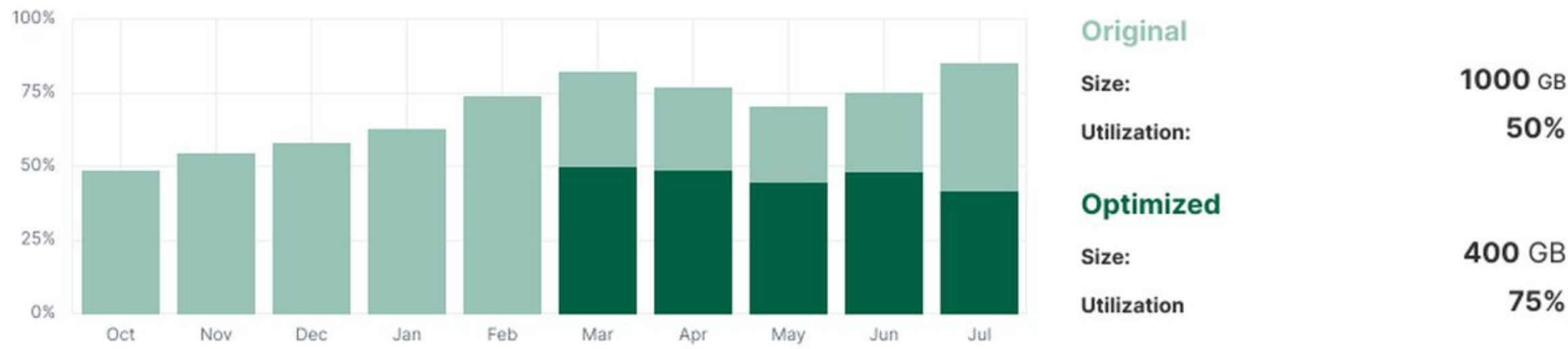
Pre-Optimization Space Used

500 GB



Post-Optimization Space Used

300 GB



Energy Usage

Understand the environmental impact of your optimization efforts in the Energy Usage Section, which illustrates changes in power consumption and their corresponding emission impacts. Here, we not only show the pre and post-optimization energy usage but also draw engaging comparisons, like equating your energy savings to the number of trees saved, to bring the environmental benefits to life.

24.5%

Energy Efficiency Improvement

An Energy Savings of

153 kWh on average

Pre-Optimization Power Usage

612 kWh



Post-Optimization Power Usage

462 kWh

Please ensure you thoroughly verify your resource for completeness and integrity before proceeding with any deletion.

Testing Post-Optimization

It is crucial for you to thoroughly test the optimized volume to ensure that the optimization process has been successful and that your volume functions as expected.

Backup Verification

We also recommend that you test the backup to confirm its integrity and completeness. This step is essential to ensure that you have a reliable fallback option.

Schedule Deletion of Original Volume

Back to Dashboard

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Backup ID: vol-01abcdefghijklmnpqrstu...

Created At: 2000-07-17 16:31:53 Resource ID: res-101 SP Reference #: 6104888294



Delete Immediately

Select this option to delete the backup right away. This option is recommended if you are confident in the success of the optimization and have verified the results.

Estimated Cost: \$0 (No additional cost)



Delete After 1 Week

Choose to automatically delete the backup after one week. This gives you a short period to test and verify the optimization results.

Estimated additional cost for 1 week: \$X.XX



Delete After 1 Month

Opt for deletion after one month if you need more time for thorough testing and verification. This period allows for extensive monitoring of the optimized resource.

Estimated additional cost for 1 month: \$X.XX



Delete After 6 Months

Select this option for a longer safety net. This extended period is ideal if you anticipate needing the backup for potential audits or further analysis.

Estimated additional cost for 6 months: \$X.XX

Delete Now

Back to Dashboard

The estimated costs are based on your current backup storage pricing and the size of the backup. These costs are additional to your regular storage costs and will be incurred only if the backup is retained beyond the immediate deletion option.

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High Resource Usage Detected

Your instance [Instance ID] is consistently operating at peak capacity.

Optimize Now



Idle Resource Alert

Volume [Volume ID] has been inactive for over 30 days.

Review Resource



Redundant Backups Found

Multiple backups detected for volume [Volume ID] without significant changes.

Manage Backups



Outdated Backup Alert

Backup [Backup ID] is over a year old and may no longer be relevant.

Update Backup



Security Vulnerability Detected

Instance [Instance ID] is running outdated software vulnerable to security threats.

Secure Now



Cost Inefficiency Identified

Potential savings detected by resizing or terminating underutilized resources.

Reduce Costs



Performance Bottleneck

Resource [Resource ID] is experiencing performance issues due to configuration limits.

Improve Performance





Staffing Needs Going Forward

Kelly Plummer

Director of Engineering & Founder

Initial role will consist of product ideation, system architecture, and optimization engineering

John Edmondson

Director of Product & Founder

Initial role will consist of product ideation, product design, and development of the frontend

(1-2) Sales & Marketing Managers

Targeted Advertising campaigns, Market research, Customer capture

(4) Software Engineers

Engineering and refining all that pertains to core software services

(2) SDT Engineers

Unit Testing and Regression Testing



Who are we competing with?

Turbonomic

IBM **Turbonomic**

Pros

- Offers proactive suggestions and performs optimizations for customers.
- Robust analysis visualizations enhance decision-making processes.

Cons

- Requires a high level of server infrastructure knowledge for effective utilization.
- Limited support for AWS services and lacks compatibility with other cloud providers.
- High pricing, geared towards large corporations, making it inaccessible for many businesses.
- Potential stagnation in product development since IBM's acquisition of Turbonomic in 2022.



Who are we competing with?

CloudHealth



Pros

- Comprehensive reporting on cloud usage and costs.
- Detailed insights and drill-down capabilities
- User-friendly interface for easy navigation and understanding of data.
- Tagging system for targeted resource management.

Cons

- Lack of automated implementation for cost optimization recommendations.
- Limited automation capabilities, requiring manual intervention for certain actions.
- Dependency on user initiative to implement changes based on recommendations.
- May not address all optimization needs, requiring additional tools or manual efforts.



On average Stewart pays Amazon Web Services **\$27,000** per month for block storage.

450
Volumes

335
Need Optimization

Model A	Model B	Model C
\$79 + \$5 / per optimization	\$199 + \$0.50 / per dollar saved	\$999 + \$0.10 / per dollar saved

Cost to Optimize
+ \$1,675

AWS Bill Reduced By
– \$11,646

Post Optimization Total
\$15,354
(First Month)

Cost to Optimize
+ \$6,700

AWS Bill Reduced By
– \$6,501

Post Optimization Total
\$20,499
(First Month)

Cost to Optimize
+ \$1,340

AWS Bill Reduced By
– \$11,061

Post Optimization Total
\$15,939
(First Month)

AWS typically charges \$0.08 per gigabyte for reserved space on a resource. Stewart's resources are resized from 750 GB to 250 GB to hit our recommendation of maintaining 80% resource utilization.



After the first month the savings continue to increase.

Model A	Model B	Model C
\$79 + \$5 / per optimization	\$199 + \$0.50 / per dollar saved	\$999 + \$0.10 / per dollar saved

Cost to Optimize + \$0	Cost to Optimize + \$0	Cost to Optimize + \$0
AWS Bill Reduced By – \$13,421	AWS Bill Reduced By – \$13,201	AWS Bill Reduced By – \$12,401
Post Optimization Total \$13,579	Post Optimization Total \$13,799	Post Optimization Total \$14,599

AWS typically charges \$0.08 per gigabyte for reserved space on a resource. Stewart's resources are resized from 750 GB to 250 GB to hit our recommendation of maintaining 80% resource utilization.



Milestone 1

Entrance Criteria:

.....
.....



Exit Criteria:

.....
.....

Revenue: \$

Burn Rate: \$

Business Goals

- Develop Single Operation capabilities
- Set and maintain a high rate of success standard for the various optimization algorithms.
- Support optimizations in a broader range of AWS services than our competitors
- Create a feedback loop with users for rapid product iteration

Market Goals

- Capture new cloud users and freelance developers through a targeted ad campaign and social outreach
- Build trust and a dedicated client base with easy-to-understand tools for small teams
- Environmental message towards providing energy & cost reduction

Milestone 1

Single
Operations

Milestone 2

Milestone 3

Milestone 4



Milestone 2

Entrance Criteria:

.....
.....



Exit Criteria:

Ensure stability in batch operations while
upholding established optimization standards

Revenue: \$

Burn Rate: \$

Business Goals

- Increase product complexity by implementing Batch Operations
- Continuous improvement of existing optimizations
- Develop optimization support for remaining AWS resources
- Develop AI Customer Support for screening customers

Market Goals

- Capture small companies and Startups with limited resources
- Continue on individual targeting by capturing pro users of LLMs
- Targeted Ad campaign
- Build customer trust that we are skilled enough to handle multiple operations at once

Milestone 1

Single
Operations

Milestone 2

Batch
Operations

Milestone 3

Milestone 4



Milestone 3

Entrance Criteria:

.....
.....



Exit Criteria:

.....
.....

Revenue: \$

Burn Rate: \$

Business Goals

- Automated operations
- Move toward reducing the internal cost of monitoring
- Increase pricing on optimization operations
- Add Google Cloud integration

Market Goals

- Prove to customers that we can be trusted managers
- Targeted campaign to capture Google Cloud customer base

Milestone 1

Single
Operations

Milestone 2

Batch
Operations

Milestone 3

Automated
Monitoring &
Optimization

Milestone 4



Milestone 1

Entrance Criteria:

.....
.....



Exit Criteria:

.....
.....

Revenue: \$

Burn Rate: \$

Business Goals

- Go to the user (i.e., CLI client, ChatGPT plugin, Discord plugin, and more)
- Offer monitoring at a lower entry-level price
- Add Azure integration

Market Goals

- Prove to customers that we can be trusted managers
- Targeted campaign to capture Azure customer base

Milestone 1

Single
Operations

Milestone 2

Batch
Operations

Milestone 3

Automated
Monitoring &
Optimization

Milestone 4

CLI & 3rd party
plugin support

**This about wraps up the
presentation. Thanks for
staying till the end!**

**Questions?
Comments?**